in his study had already indicated was a stronghold of the Jamaat-i-Islami. A focus group was conducted in this department with faculty members who sat in a segregated classroom. Their response to the question of which political party they supported was that it depended on who did good work, and insisted that they had '*no allegiance to any one party*'. Political activism then was '*not considered "good*"' (Academic, Male, Lahore), while another described it as '*Muasharati tabaahi aur afra tafri*'[29] (Academic, Female, Lahore). However, in other narratives participants did attempt to provide a balanced definition with some highlighting how '*political activism is very essential to survive in a state like Pakistan*' but also problematized this statement by asking '*what politics is?*' (Student, Male, Lahore); '*To take a part in different parties and to be aware of political current issues*' (Female, Student, Lahore); '*means used to gain favor of the people*' (Female, Student, Lahore); '*Siyaasi soch ki bedaari*'[30] (Female, Student, Karachi); '*A person or campaign work through various activities of political parties and management of that party*' (Academic, Male, Quetta).

While these definitions provided a generic understanding of political activism, participants also shared the extent to which they themselves were both politically aware and politically active. The narratives around political awareness predominantly evoked a passive level of political awareness. Again from getting news through the internet, to being '*aware of the ups and downs in the politics of our country*', to watching 'media', talk shows and 'news channels'. However, young people also used being 'a student' as an excuse for not being politically aware, while for others their source of information was their parents: '*Not that much. As I am a student so I don't get time*' (Student, Female, Quetta); '*Yeah because my father is politically active*' (Student, Female, Lahore).

The disconnect between being a student and political activism goes against the tradition of political activism that had been prevalent in universities in the past, more so with student groups associated with political parties. However, this also highlights the changing nature of the university where students are burdened with work to such an extent that other issues around rights and politics become irrelevant (see Jinnah Institute 2013; Nelson 2011). For others the link to politics came through their fathers who they believed to be politically aware so would inform them about the political situation in the country. The difference between the parents' generation who were students during the period described in the preceding section, and their own generation's level of political activism was also a subject of discussion. The responses from the focus groups were mixed, with some arguing that their parents were politically active while others arguing that they were less so than them. Figure 2.1a and 2.1b highlights the trends in these